FREE FAITH GUIDE

Beloved *First*

BELOVED FIRST. TO-DO LIST SECOND.



MATTHEW 3

Chaotic Sunshine

Loved *before* the list.

Everything for one honest conversation: the lesson, the back story, the questions, memory cards and a coloring page.

1 · LESSON RECAP
2 · BACK STORY
3 · TALK IT THROUGH
4 · MEMORY CARDS
5 · COLORING PAGE

LESSON RECAP

Your to-do list has its own to-do list. Heaven spoke first anyway.

Jesus came to the Jordan to be baptized before He had preached a sermon, healed a leper or fed a crowd. As He came up out of the water, heaven opened, the Spirit descended like a dove, and the Father said, "...This is my Son, whom I love; with him I am well pleased" (Matthew 3:17). Delight came first, and the work flowed out of it. Right after, the tempter opened with "If you are the Son of God..." (Matthew 4:3). Jesus answered from Scripture and from a settled name. In Christ, the order is the same for you: beloved, then sent.

ONE WORD IN MATTHEW 3:17

eudokeo

GREEK · YOO-DOK-EH-OH

To be well pleased, to take delight in. Translated "well pleased" here. Delight spoken before any results.

	The order we flip	*The order at the Jordan*
FIRST	Do enough, then maybe rest	Hear "...whom I love..." (Matthew 3:17)
THEN	Prove it when the "if" comes	Answer from Scripture (Matthew 4:4)
AFTER	Work to earn the word	Work flows out of it (Matthew 4:17)

"...This is my Son, whom I love; with him I am well pleased."

MATTHEW 3:17 · NIV

TAKE THIS HOME

Beloved first. To-do list second.

NOTICE THE ORDER

No sermons yet. No healings. No crowds fed. Then: "From that time on Jesus began to preach..." (Matthew 4:17, NIV).

delight came first. the work flowed out of it.

THE BACK STORY

Meanwhile, at the Jordan River...

BOOK ID CARD

Book: The Gospel of Matthew
Written by: Traditionally the apostle Matthew, a former tax collector (Matthew 9:9)
Scene: The Jordan River, then the wilderness, then Galilee
Jesus' age: "...about thirty..." (Luke 3:23)

thirty quiet years. already loved.

What was going on

John the Baptist is preaching repentance and baptizing in the Jordan (Matthew 3:1-6). Jesus comes from Galilee to be baptized, and John tries to stop Him (3:13-14). Jesus says it is right "...to fulfill all righteousness" (3:15).

As Jesus comes up out of the water, heaven opens, the Spirit descends like a dove, and the voice speaks (3:16-17). Then the Spirit leads Him into the wilderness, where the tempter opens with "if" (4:1-3).

Read the scene like a playlist

Matthew 3:13-15
Jesus comes to the Jordan.

Matthew 3:16
Heaven opens. The Spirit descends.

Matthew 3:17
The voice speaks delight.

Matthew 4:1-17
The wilderness, then the ministry.

Why it matters

Many scholars hear two Old Testament echoes in the Father's words: "...You are my son..." (Psalm 2:7) and "...my chosen one in whom I delight..." (Isaiah 42:1). Son and servant, loved before the work.

Luke says Jesus was "...about thirty years old when he began his ministry..." (Luke 3:23). The delight landed on quiet years with no recorded sermons or miracles.

SO WHAT?

You don't work for the word. You work from it.

the enemy still opens with "if."

IF THIS STIRS UP A LOT

If your worth has felt tied to your output for a long time, talking with a counselor, pastor or trusted friend is a strong move. In a crisis, call or text 988, any time.

TALK IT THROUGH · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Pull up a chair.

BRING
A snack, a pen and your honest self.

WHO
3 to 8 friends. "Pass" is always allowed.

TABLE RULE
What's shared here stays here.

SPARK · 5 MIN

What's one thing you write on a to-do list just to cross it off?

host goes first. no judgment.

READ IT OUT LOUD · 5 MIN

Read **Matthew 3:13-4:4** together. Listen for what Jesus had done before the voice spoke, and how He answers the "if."

QUESTIONS · 25 MIN · START LIGHT, GO DEEPER

1. When did someone love you before you had done a thing to earn it?
2. Remember a time you worked hard for approval God had already given. What were you trying to prove?
3. The Father spoke delight before the ministry started. What would change in your week if you started your mornings in that order?
4. The tempter opened with "...If you are the Son of God..." Why do you think he went after identity first?
5. **Deep End:** Finish this sentence: The "if" the enemy whispers about me most is...

60 SECONDS FIRST
Before work, hear the Father's words over you: beloved, pleasing to Him. Then go.

A QUIET GIFT
Do one task this week as a gift to another woman, no credit needed.

SAY IT BACK
Tape the mirror card (page 4) where you get ready: Beloved first. To-do list second.

CLOSE IN PRAYER

Father, You said of Jesus, "...This is my Son, whom I love..." In Him, speak that delight over us before we do anything today. When the "if" comes, settle us in what You already said. Let our work flow out of Your love, not toward it. Amen.

KEEP THE JOY COMING

Get the Sunshine Mail.

One Sunday a month: Scripture, an honest reflection, and a little room for surprises.

Share your table on Instagram **@chaoticsunshinetable**.

chaoticsunshine.com

SCAN TO SIGN UP

CUT ON THE DASHED LINES

MEMORY VERSE

"...This is my Son, whom I love; with him I am well pleased."

MATTHEW 3:17 · NIV

MIRROR CARD

Beloved *first.* To-do list second.

MATTHEW 3:17 · NIV

tape me where you get ready.

POCKET REMINDER

I said it first.

"You are My beloved daughter. I said it first."
Read this before you open your inbox.

delight came first. the work flowed out of it.

COLOR ME

Beloved first

MATTHEW 3:17 · NIV

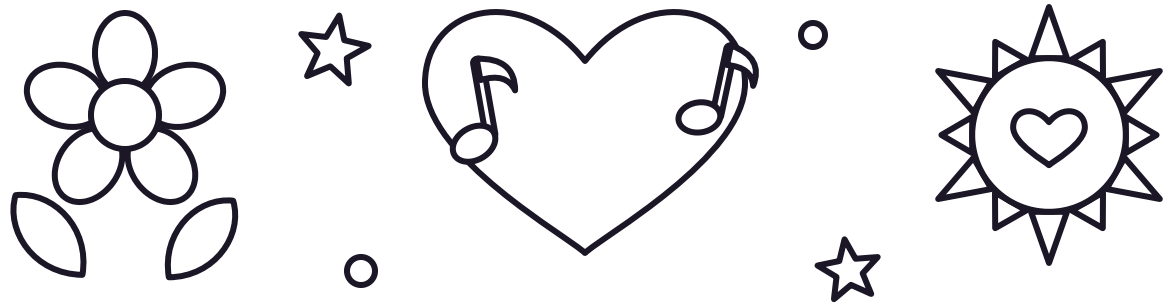


Beloved first.

then the list

...whom I love; with him I am well pleased.

MATTHEW 3:17 · NIV



Margin Notes

Before my to-do list, God says:

Sunshine Mail

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